

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6
 ♥ 8 6 4
 ♦ K Q 10 7
 ♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
 ♦ A 5
 ♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
 ♥ 9 7
 ♦ 9 3 2
 ♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
 ♥ A K
 ♦ J 8 6 4
 ♣ 7 5 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North hand as a whole.			

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♥7.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

You need to find West with the ♠A to avoid two losers in the suit. But even if he has the card you must still be careful. You are in dummy right now, and you are only going to be in dummy once more.

Right now you must lead a ♠ toward your hand and put up the ♠K when West plays low. When this wins the trick return to dummy with a trump and play another ♠ toward the ♠Q. When this also wins you can pull trumps, not before.

It may go against the grain not to start pulling trumps immediately, but the urgency to remove the enemy trumps must be weighed against the best plan for the

Here there was no realistic hope of making this contract without playing twice toward your ♠ K Q.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
 ♥ A 6 3
 ♦ Q 10 6 4
 ♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

West	North	East	South
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2NT	Pass	3♦	Pass
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5♦

All Pass

5♦ by East

Instead, win the first trick and immediately play your ♠ toward dummy's ♠ K Q. A defender will probably take this trick but you don't care. They will play another ♣ to try to set up a trick in the suit but you can win the ♣, enter dummy with the ♥A, and discard your "slow" ♣ loser on dummy's good ♠ honor.

And then, with that important job done, you can lead trumps.

Bridge is a game of timing, and sometimes the tempo of the game is set by the opening lead.

Suppose South's opening lead was a ♠, a ♥ or a ♦. You would have still had the same 3 losers, but now the ♣ loser would have been "very slow". So slow that you could start on trumps before working on the ♠s.

In other words, with one of these opening leads a mediocre player, one who had never read this lesson, would probably make the contract without any trouble. But with the ♣ lead only a skilled declarer would make it!

East is to play 5♦. South leads the ♣10. You play dummy's ♣J and North puts on the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 3

The ♠ loser and ♦ loser are "fast" losers, meaning your opponents can take them whenever they are in the lead. The ♣ loser is a "slow" loser, meaning you might have some time to dispose of it.

But here is the problem. If you start to draw trumps, a defender will take the ♦A and play another ♣, forcing out your ♣Q. Then, when you play a ♠ they will jump in with the ♠A and take their ♣ trick. Anything you can think of to do about that?

Once you recognize the problem, the solution is easier to see. Don't play trumps next!

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 6

♥ 8 6 4

♦ K Q 10 7

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ 9 3 2

♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2

♥ A K

♦ J 8 6 4

♣ 7 5 3

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 9

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 15

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6

♥ 8 6 4

♦ K Q 10 7

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ 9 3 2

♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2

♥ A K

♦ J 8 6 4

♣ 7 5 3

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ A 2

N

W E

S

♠ J 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ 9 3 2

♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2

♥ A K

♦ J 8 6 4

♣ 7 5 3

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 21

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 6

♥ 8 6 4

♦ K Q 10 7

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ 9 3 2

♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2

♥ A K

♦ J 8 6 4

♣ 7 5 3

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 25

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 27

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3
♥ J 9 7 2
♦ 7
♣ K 7 4



♠ 8
♥ K Q 5
♦ K J 9 8 5 2
♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2
♥ 10 8 4
♦ A 3
♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 29

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8
♥ K Q 5
♦ K J 9 8 5 2
♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2

 N
W E
 S

♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 7 4



♠ 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ K J 9 8 5 2

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 4

♦ A 3

♣ 10 9 8 3

Board 35

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 8 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7
♣ Q 10 8

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q J 10 5 3 2
♦ A 5
♣ A 2



♠ J 10 5
♥ 9 7
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K J 9 6 4

♠ 8 7 3 2
♥ A K
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ 7 5 3

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ A 10 9 4 3
♥ J 9 7 2
♦ 7
♣ K 7 4



♠ 8
♥ K Q 5
♦ K J 9 8 5 2
♣ A 6 2

♠ J 6 5 2
♥ 10 8 4
♦ A 3
♣ 10 9 8 3